



(L-R) THE TAJ MAHAL HOTEL ON FIRE; CHHATRAPATI SHIVAJI TERMINUS; ONE OF THE TERRORISTS AT THE TERMINUS



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By Malini Bhupta with Aditi Pai

Just as 9/11 entered the dictionary of terror, so too will 26/11, the day which will go down as Mumbai's darkest hour, when terrorists laid siege to the city's roads, airports, railway station, hospitals and two of its best known luxury hotels, leaving a trail of death and destruction and taking hostages. The scenes were devastating: explosions, raging fires, dead bodies, heavily armed terrorists with rucksacks containing grenades and explosives and firing indiscriminately at people on the streets, and a metropolis on its knees. The most heart-rending sight was Mumbai's most iconic and beautiful building, the 106-year-old heritage wing of the Taj Mahal Hotel, reduced to a blackened ruin. By daybreak, almost 11 hours after the attack started, the official

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and 300 injured.

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nces? What should India's response be?